

ARCANA

OVERVIEW

Arcana is a deck-building game for 2-4 players. Players begin with basic decks and alter it by acquiring powerful cards from the market. Use your deck strategically to conquer monsters, attack opponents, gather Arcana, and complete a mystical ritual to attain cosmic power.

Setup

1. Player Setup:

- Each player begins with:
 - 8 Copper cards
 - 2 Slice cards
 - 30 HP
- Create two piles in front of each player: a **Draw pile** (initially containing all 10 starting cards) and a **Discard pile** (initially empty).

2. Table Setup:

- Stack basic cards (**Copper, Silver, Gold, Slice, Carve, Bludgeon, Arcana**) each in separate piles.
- Combine the Market deck (170 cards) and Monster deck (30 cards) into a single shuffled 200-card deck.
- Deal 6 cards from this combined deck onto the table. This is "The market"

Gameplay

Players take turns, proceeding clockwise around the table. Each turn has the following phases:

1. Draw Phase

- Draw up to a hand of five cards.

- If your Draw pile is insufficient, draw the remaining cards, shuffle your Discard pile into a new Draw pile, then draw until you have five cards.

2. Play Phase

- Play cards from your hand to gain gold, acquire Arcana, deal damage, or trigger special effects.

3. Combat Phase

- You may use attack cards to deal damage to monsters or other players.
 - **Defeating Monsters:** If a monster is defeated, turn the card over and immediately gain its Treasure (instant boon) or Relic (permanent bonus).
 - **Player Attacks:** Dealing damage to another player reduces their HP. A player whose HP reaches 0 is eliminated.
- **Instant Cards:** Can be played at any time, including outside your turn, to damage or disrupt opponents. Instants resolve in reverse order (last played instant resolves first).

4. Purchase Phase

- You may purchase cards from the 6 cards available on the table or basic card piles, spending accumulated gold. Purchased cards go directly to your discard pile.
- You have one purchase per turn by default. Unspent gold is lost at the end of the turn.

5. End Phase

- Discard any number of cards from your hand to your discard pile. You cannot discard **Darkness** cards.
- Any card specifically discarded during gameplay moves to your discard pile at the end of this phase.

Terminology

- **Discard:** All discarded cards disappear from your hand immediately and appear into your discard pile at the end of the turn (this prevents infinities).
- **Exhaust:** Exhausted cards are permanently removed from the game.

- **Darkness:** These are unplayable cards and do not get discarded at the end of your turn. If you ever hold five Darkness cards simultaneously, you are eliminated from the game.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

Attain cosmic power and win by either:

- Eliminating all other players.
- Being the first player to reach **50 Arcana points**. Arcana points represent your progress towards completing the ritual to gain cosmic power.

DECK BREAKDOWN

- **Market Cards:** 170 cards
- **Monster Cards:** 30 cards
- **Basic Cards:** Unlimited supply (practically 10 each for gameplay purposes)

RECENT CHANGES & PATCH NOTES

- Reduced the total number of Market cards from **10** to **6** to reduce reading time at the start of each round.
- Increased costs:
 - **Carve:** Increased to 4 gold
 - **Bludgeon:** Increased to 7 gold
- These adjustments discourage the previously boring dominant strategy of quickly acquiring basic Carves and rapidly defeating other players.
- Reduced Arcana points needed for victory from **77** to **50** to prevent drawn-out games where the outcome is already evident.

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Feel free to contact me if you have any questions at wenyeyzhou51@gmail.com